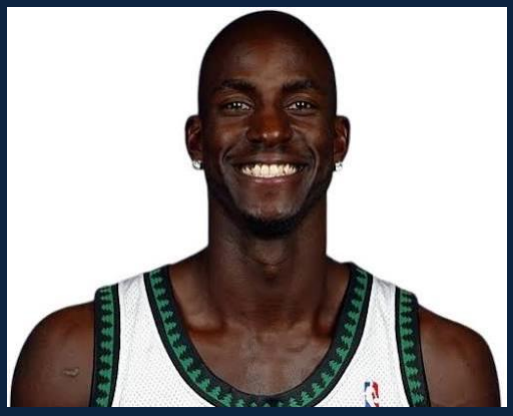
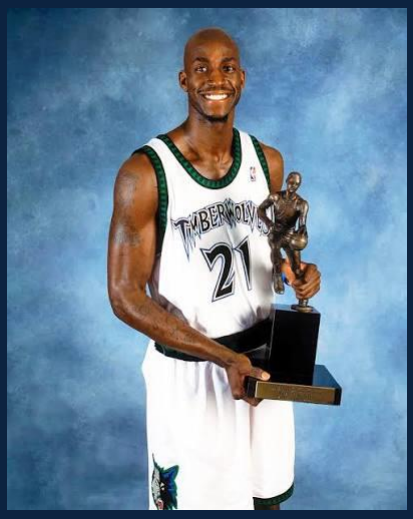
KEVIN GARNETT

#21 • FORWARD / CENTER • 6'11" • 220 lbs

Minnesota Timberwolves, Boston Celtics & Brooklyn Nets





BORN	May 19, 1976 - Mauldin, South Carolina
HIGH SCHOOL	Farragut Career Academy (Chicago, IL)
COLLEGE	None - entered draft directly from high school
DRAFTED	1995 - 1st Round, 5th Overall, Minnesota Timberwolves
EXPERIENCE	21 NBA Seasons
ACCOLADES	15x All-Star, 2004 NBA MVP, 2008 NBA Champion, 2008 Defensive Player of the Year, 4x NBA Rebounding Champion, Naismith Basketball Hall of Fame (2020)

BIOGRAPHY

Kevin Garnett is one of the most versatile and intense competitors ever to play the power forward position. Selected fifth overall by the Minnesota Timberwolves in the 1995 NBA Draft directly out of Farragut Career Academy in Chicago, Garnett was among the first wave of players to make the jump from high school to the professional ranks. This was a decision that helped reshape the league's approach to young talent for a generation, including athletes such as LeBron James, Tracy McGrady, and Kobe Bryant, who all went directly to the NBA from high school.

Over 21 NBA seasons with Minnesota, Boston, and Brooklyn, Garnett developed a reputation for his rare blend of size, agility, perimeter shooting touch, and defensive ferocity. He earned NBA Most Valuable Player honors in 2004 after leading the Timberwolves to the Western Conference Finals, and he anchored a dominant Boston Celtics defense that captured the 2008 NBA Championship alongside Paul Pierce and Ray Allen, earning Defensive Player of the Year honors that same season.

A 15-time NBA All-Star and four-time rebounding champion, Garnett is widely regarded as one of the premier defensive anchors and vocal leaders of his era. He was inducted into the Naismith Memorial Basketball Hall of Fame in 2020, and his No. 21 jersey has been honored by the Minnesota Timberwolves organization he helped put on the map.

Off the court, Garnett has remained closely tied to the Twin Cities community and has been an advocate for youth basketball development programs. He is known throughout the league for his fiery, high-energy approach to practice and preparation, a trait teammates and coaches consistently credit as contagious within a locker room. Garnett is also known for being one of the best-trash talkers in NBA history according to Bleacher Report.

CAREER STATISTICS FROM SELECTED SEASONS

Season	Team	GP	PPG	RPG	APG	BPG	FG%
1995-96	MIN	80	10.4	6.3	1.8	1.6	.491
1998-99	MIN	47	20.8	10.4	4.3	1.8	.460
2000-01	MIN	81	22.0	11.4	5.0	1.8	.477
2003-04	MIN	82	24.2	13.9	5.0	2.2	.499
2007-08	BOS	71	18.8	9.2	3.4	1.3	.539
2012-13	BOS	76	14.8	7.8	2.6	1.1	.469
2015-16	MIN	69	6.5	6.4	1.5	1.1	.497
CAREER	—	1,462	17.8	10.0	3.7	1.7	.497

IN HIS OWN WORDS

"At the end of the day, you're responsible for yourself and your actions and that's all you can control. So rather than be frustrated with what you can't control, try to fix the things you can." Kevin Garnett



QUICK HITS

- Nickname: "The Big Ticket" / "KG"
- Jersey retired by the Minnesota Timberwolves (No. 21)
- 2008 NBA Champion - Boston Celtics
- 2004 NBA Most Valuable Player
- 2008 NBA Defensive Player of the Year
- Naismith Memorial Basketball Hall of Fame, Class of 2020

HIGH SCHOOL CAREER

Garnett did not play college basketball. He is one of a small group of players from the 1990s who entered the NBA directly from high school, a path that was legal at the time but became far less common after the league later instituted an age-minimum requirement. His high school resume remains one of the most decorated in the country's history and is a central part of his basketball story.

Garnett began his high school career at Mauldin High School in Mauldin, South Carolina, where he earned all-state recognition, before transferring for his senior season to Farragut Career Academy in Chicago, Illinois. The move to Chicago introduced him to a higher level of national competition and significantly raised his recruiting and draft profile.

HIGH SCHOOL(S)	Mauldin HS (Mauldin, SC) then Farragut Career Academy (Chicago, IL)
SENIOR SEASON (Farragut)	~25.2 PPG, 17.9 RPG, 6.5 BPG, 6.7 APG

HONORS	Illinois Mr. Basketball (1995); USA Today All-USA First Team; Parade All-American; McDonald's All-American Game MVP (1995); Naismith Prep Player of the Year finalist
COLLEGE COMMITMENT	Garnett skipped college entirely and entered the 1995 NBA Draft directly out of high school

CAREER STATS BY TEAM

The table below breaks down Garnett's career scoring and rebounding averages across each stop of his 21-year NBA career.

Team	Seasons	Yrs	PPG	RPG	APG	BPG	FG%
Minnesota Timberwolves	1995-2007	12	20.5	11.4	4.5	1.8	.497
Boston Celtics	2007-2013	6	16.6	8.7	3.0	1.2	.501
Brooklyn Nets	2013-2015	2	6.9	6.9	1.8	0.9	.442
Minnesota Timberwolves (return)	2015-2016	1	6.5	6.4	1.5	1.1	.497

ALL-STAR & NATIONAL TEAM HONORS

Garnett was selected to 15 NBA All-Star Games across his career (1997, 2000-2011, 2013), one of the longer active All-Star runs of his generation. He was named All-Star Game MVP in 2003 after posting a game-high stat line in a losing effort, and he started the majority of his All-Star appearances at forward for the Western Conference before later representing the Eastern Conference following his 2007 trade to Boston.

On the international stage, Garnett represented USA Basketball as a member of the 2000 U.S. Olympic Team in Sydney, Australia, helping the roster capture the gold medal. He also suited up for USA Basketball in exhibition and qualifying competition earlier in his career, part of a core of NBA talent that represented the program through the late 1990s and early 2000s.

HONORS & AWARDS

- NBA Most Valuable Player - 2003-04
- NBA Defensive Player of the Year - 2007-08
- NBA Champion - 2007-08 (Boston Celtics)
- NBA All-Star - 15x (1997, 2000-2011, 2013)
- NBA All-Star Game MVP - 2003
- All-NBA First Team - 4x (2000, 2003, 2004, 2008)
- All-NBA Second/Third Team - 5x (various seasons)
- NBA All-Defensive First Team - 9x
- NBA Rebounding Champion - 4x (2004, 2005, 2006, 2007)
- Olympic Gold Medalist - 2000 (Sydney, Australia)
- Illinois Mr. Basketball - 1995
- McDonald's All-American Game MVP - 1995
- Naismith Memorial Basketball Hall of Fame - Class of 2020
- Jersey Retired - Minnesota Timberwolves, No. 21 (2022)

FRANCHISE HISTORY - MINNESOTA TIMBERWOLVES

The Minnesota Timberwolves joined the NBA as an expansion franchise in 1989, bringing NBA basketball back to Minnesota for the first time since the Minneapolis Lakers relocated to Los Angeles in 1960. The franchise struggled through its early seasons before the 1995 NBA Draft, in which the club selected Kevin Garnett fifth overall - a move that would come to define the organization's identity for more than a decade.

Behind Garnett, the Timberwolves qualified for the playoffs eight consecutive seasons (1996-97 through 2003-04) and reached the Western Conference Finals in 2004, the deepest postseason run in franchise history. Garnett was traded to the Boston Celtics in the summer of 2007 in a deal that reshaped both franchises. He returned to Minnesota for the 2015-16 season in a mentorship role before retiring from the NBA in 2016 as a member of the organization that drafted him. In 2022, the Timberwolves retired his No. 21 jersey, and a statue honoring Garnett now stands outside the team's downtown Minneapolis arena.

SERIES HISTORY VS. SELECTED OPPONENTS

A season-series snapshot of the Timberwolves' all-time regular-season record against Northwest and Western Conference rivals during the Garnett era (1995-2007):

Opponent	All-Time Series (Reg. Season)	Notable Postseason Meetings
Denver Nuggets	48-40	None
Portland Trail Blazers	44-46	None
Utah Jazz	40-50	None
Sacramento Kings	37-53	2004 West. Conf. Semifinals (MIN won 4-3)
Los Angeles Lakers	34-58	2003, 2004 Playoffs
San Antonio Spurs	30-62	None

TEAM RECORDS

- Franchise all-time leading scorer - Kevin Garnett, 19,041 points
- Franchise all-time leading rebounder - Kevin Garnett, 10,415 rebounds
- Franchise single-season rebounding record - Kevin Garnett, 1,183 rebounds (2003-04)
- Franchise record for consecutive playoff appearances - 8 seasons (1996-97 to 2003-04)

ARENA INFORMATION - TARGET CENTER

Home Arena: Target Center, 600 First Avenue North, Minneapolis, MN 55403. Opened in 1990, Target Center seats approximately 19,356 for basketball. The arena underwent a major renovation completed in 2017, adding upgraded concourses, a new grand entry plaza, and expanded premium seating. Media parking is available in the attached ramp off First Avenue North with credential verification at the media entrance on the arena's east side.

MEDIA INFORMATION

Credential Requests: All media credential requests must be submitted no later than 48 hours prior to tip-off through the team's media credentialing portal. Approved credentials may be picked up at the media will-call window at the East Plaza entrance beginning three hours before game time.

Broadcast Media: Rights-holding broadcast partners should coordinate camera and announcer positions with the Communications Department at least one week in advance of the visit. Non-rights-holders are limited to designated highlight-access windows per league broadcast policy.

Interview Requests: Postgame locker room access opens approximately 10 minutes after the final buzzer, per league media-access policy. Pregame player and coach availability is arranged through the Communications Department and is typically held 60-75 minutes prior to tip-off. One-on-one interview requests should be submitted at least 24 hours in advance and are granted at the discretion of the Communications staff.

Working Media Room: A media workroom with wired internet access, monitors, and postgame transcript service is located adjacent to the interview room on the event level.

SPORTS INFORMATION DEPARTMENT	Minnesota Timberwolves Communications Department led by Chief Communications Officer Patrick Rees
MAILING ADDRESS	600 Hennepin Ave, Suite 300, Minneapolis, MN 55403
MAIN OFFICE PHONE	(612) 555-0143
SOCIAL MEDIA	@Timberwolves (X/Instagram)